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The effects of eWom triggered service recovery on customer citizenship behavior in the hospitality industry: The moderating role of failure severity

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Abstract

This study examines service failures in the hospitality industry, amplified by the shift to online platforms, and highlights the need for effective online recovery methods. These methods are crucial for retaining existing customers and preventing potential customer loss. Despite its importance, customer citizenship behavior resulting from service recovery must be noticed. This study examines the impact of service failure severity and online recovery methods on customer citizenship behavior, employing six scenarios varying in severity and recovery strategies. Multi-group scanning electron microscope analysis reveals that justice types positively influence recovery satisfaction, enhancing customer citizenship behaviors. Failure severity moderates the relationship between recovery satisfaction and customer citizenship behavior, with recovery satisfaction being more effective in promoting advocacy and tolerance behaviors during low-severity failures. However, this effect diminishes in high-severity failures. Effective recovery strategies can transform negative service failures into positive outcomes for hospitality organizations.

KEYWORDS

customer citizenship behavior, failure severity, online recovery, service failures

1 | INTRODUCTION

Online travel agencies, emerging with the development of internet technologies, have substantially altered the purchasing process of tourism products (Buhalis & Law, 2008; Kontis & Skoutos, 2022). Currently, processes such as searching for information, determining alternatives, and making purchases are primarily conducted online (Chen et al., 2022; Liu et al., 2019). In these processes, customers benefit from company and consumer-generated information (Akhtar et al., 2019; Wong & Qi, 2017). The intangible characteristics of tourism products that are difficult to assess before consumption (Tsao, 2018; Tung et al., 2017) lead customers to pay more attention

to online consumer reviews (Bigne et al., 2020; Tran, 2020). Thanks to their importance in the decision-making process, it has become a global trend for customers to share their experiences and opinions about tourism products on the internet (Wong & Qi, 2017). Shared experiences often mention issues such as service failures (Honora et al., 2022; Manu & Sreejesh, 2020). Negative reviews and complaints shared online following a poor service experience also refer to customers' responses to service failures (Liu et al., 2019; Yang & Ha, 2023). Weitzl and Hutzinger (2019) argue that customers express dissatisfaction with service failures on online platforms to make their voices heard. Previous studies have indicated that customers share negative opinions about an organization only with their close

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contacts, such as friends and relatives, following a service failure, but advances in internet technology have transformed service failures into online reviews that can reach a larger audience and negatively influence their decisions (Liu et al., 2019; Yang & Ha, 2023). The adverse effects of the growing number of negative reviews on potential customers' decisions have led online platforms to provide organizations with the opportunity to respond to these reviews (Ekiz et al., 2012). Service failures refer to situations where the service does not meet customer expectations (Barari et al., 2020; Parasuraman et al., 1991; Rohden & Matos, 2022). Service recoveries, on the other hand, refer to the corrective responses of the organization (Hsieh & Yeh, 2018; Koç, 2019). In this context, service failures turn into online negative reviews, and corrective responses, such as apologies and compensations for these reviews, are considered online service recoveries (Honora et al., 2022; Surachartkumtonkun et al., 2021).

Due to the movement of service failures and recovery efforts to online platforms (Honora et al., 2022; Liu et al., 2019), it is predicted that organizations that fail to satisfy their existing customers will also lose potential customers due to the negative experiences shared online (Guo et al., 2020; Park et al., 2021). On the other hand, it is possible that a customer who is dissatisfied due to service failure can be satisfied with a successful recovery (Kim, So, et al., 2022; Kuzgun et al., 2022). Previous studies have demonstrated that successful recovery could restore satisfaction, build longer customer relationships, restore trust, increase repurchase intentions, enhance customer loyalty, and decrease the tendency to share negative reviews (Akarsu et al., 2023; Cahyanto et al., 2021; Derham et al., 2022; Holloway & Beatty, 2003; Hsieh & Yeh, 2018; Kim, Du, et al., 2022; Lee, 2018; Liu et al., 2019; Rohden & Matos, 2022). In this context, organizations should develop customer-oriented online recovery strategies against service failures shared on online platforms (Honora et al., 2022; Surachartkumtonkun et al., 2021) to transform the negative consequences into positive outcomes (Dwesar & Sahoo, 2022; Kim, Du, et al., 2022).

The characteristics of the hospitality industry, including intangibility, heterogeneity, perishability, and simultaneous production and consumption (Lee, 2018; Praesri et al., 2022; Tsao, 2018; Zeithaml et al., 1985), as well as the inherent complexity of operations, lead service failures inevitable (Akarsu et al., 2023; Kim, Du, et al., 2022). On the other hand, service failures can induce customers to develop negative emotions, giving rise to negative behaviors (Hur & Jang, 2019) and sharing negative reviews online (Surachartkumtonkun et al., 2021). Nevertheless, the potential negative consequences of such failures can be avoided through effective recovery strategies (Adil et al., 2022; Tosun et al., 2022). Consequently, service failures also provide an opportunity to benefit from the potential positive outcomes of successful service recoveries (Jeong & Lee, 2017; Sreejesh et al., 2019). Related studies (Dwesar & Sahoo, 2022; Kim, Du, et al., 2022) have focused on transforming the negative consequences of service failures into positive outcomes instead of focusing on prevention. One of the positive outcomes that can be achieved following a successful service recovery is customer citizenship behavior, which refers to the positive voluntary behavior of customers towards the

organization (Zhu et al., 2021). While organizations used to focus mainly on employees to gain competitive advantage (Yi & Gong, 2006), a new approach has emerged in recent years that focuses on customers (Gong & Yi, 2021; Kim & Choi, 2016; Mitrega et al., 2022). There is a growing interest in voluntary positive extra-role behaviors by customers to enhance global competitiveness, especially in service industries heavily involved in international markets, such as tourism (Hossain et al., 2020; Lara et al., 2017). Currently, the role of the customer is evolving from being solely a service receiver (Chung, 2006) to a volunteer employee (Gong & Yi, 2021; Woo, 2019) who has an impact on various aspects, including the quality and performance of the organization (Bove et al., 2009; Choi & Lotz, 2016; Xie et al., 2017). Voluntary customer behaviors have become an increasingly crucial issue for organizations (Tonder et al., 2018; Zhu et al., 2021) to achieve sustainable competitive advantage (Ahn et al., 2016; Bove et al., 2009; Fowler, 2013; Tung et al., 2017) through improved quality and performance (Liu et al., 2020; Xie et al., 2017).

This study differs from existing studies in several ways. First, it focuses on customer citizenship behavior in the context of service failures, a topic that has yet to be largely overlooked in the existing literature. Although the social exchange theory (Blau, 1964) provides an appropriate theoretical framework to explain the relationship between service recovery and customer citizenship behavior, it has received limited attention. Thus, further research is needed to fully understand this phenomenon (Zhu et al., 2021). Zhu et al. (2021) conducted the only research on this topic in online retail. While the study focused on justice theory and recovery expectations, the effect of failure severity on citizenship behavior was not investigated. However, the literature suggests that regardless of the recovery type, the severity of failure affects behavioral intentions (Krishna et al., 2014; Sparks & Fredline, 2007). This leads to the conclusion that customers who experience different severity of service failure are likely to exhibit different levels of citizenship behaviors. The fact that this study examines the relationship between service recovery and customer citizenship behavior in the context of the hospitality industry and focuses on the effect of failure severity on this relationship distinguishes this study from other studies in the literature.

Secondly, this study addresses the issue of service failures in the context of online platforms, which have a significant impact on the hospitality industry. Although there are many studies on service failures and recovery methods, only a few have been conducted in the context of online platforms. On the other hand, online platforms have become crucial issues that significantly affect hospitality organizations (Akhtar et al., 2019; Kontis & Skoultos, 2022). Currently, the trend of customers sharing their service failure experiences on online platforms puts hospitality organizations at risk of losing their potential customers (Fu et al., 2022; Honora et al., 2022). The growing prevalence of internet usage in the purchase of tourism products (Kontis & Skoultos, 2022; Liu et al., 2019) and the increasing importance of online consumer reviews (Bigne et al., 2020; Tran, 2020) make it critical to address the issue of service failures and recovery methods in the context of online platforms. Nevertheless, previous research indicated that responsiveness could engender a positive impression

among users of review sites, yet this impact on service recovery outcomes remains unclear (Liu et al., 2019). Thus, further investigation is needed to understand the role of e-WOM media in the online recovery process.

Lastly, this study explains the ongoing debate about the relative effectiveness of different types of justice in terms of recovery satisfaction. Previous studies conducted in the context of justice theory have revealed inconsistent results regarding which kind of justice is more effective on recovery satisfaction (Ali et al., 2023; Kuo & Wu, 2012; Rojas et al., 2015; Smith et al., 1999; Stokburger-Sauer & Hofmann, 2023). Further research is needed to identify the factors contributing to these inconsistent results. Miller et al. (2000) suggest that customers who experience different types of service failures may develop different recovery expectations. Setting different recovery expectations leads customers to give varying degrees of importance to various kinds of justice regarding their recovery satisfaction. This study differs from previous studies by focusing on the effects of failure severity on the relationship between justice types and recovery satisfaction.

This study examines the effects of recovery efforts made through responses to negative online reviews on customer citizenship behavior, focusing on the moderating effect of failure severity. We used justice, social exchange, and prospect theories to develop a multi-group research model in which perceived justice affects recovery satisfaction, customer citizenship behavior, and the moderating effect of failure severity in these relationships.

2 | THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

2.1 | Justice theory and recovery satisfaction

Studies on service failures and recovery methods commonly use justice theory to measure customer perceptions and assess post-purchase behaviors (Ali et al., 2023; Liu et al., 2019). Service recovery is when the organization redistributes justice to its customers who experience failures and dissatisfaction with service consumption (Liu et al., 2019). Tax et al. (1998) argue that customers assess service recovery based on recovery process, communication, and outcomes. Justice theory, with its different types of justice which refer to the recovery process (procedural justice), communication (interactional justice), and the outcomes (distributive justice) is a valuable approach for understanding the emotional responses and evaluating the attitudes of customers who experience service failure (Blodgett et al., 1997; Hoffman & Kelley, 2000; Zhu et al., 2021). Customers evaluate the recovery process's effectiveness based on their perception of justice (Gelbrich & Roschk, 2011). Therefore, an increase in perceived justice leads to an increase in recovery satisfaction (DeWitt et al., 2008; Karatepe, 2006; Manu & Sreejesh, 2020). Following this idea, we propose the H1 and its sub-hypotheses, which state that customers' perception of justice during the recovery process impacts their recovery satisfaction.

H1. Perceived justice positively affects recovery satisfaction.

H1a. Distributive justice positively affects recovery satisfaction.

H1b. Interactional justice positively affects recovery satisfaction.

H1c. Procedural justice positively affects recovery satisfaction.

2.2 | Recovery satisfaction and customer citizenship behavior

Customer citizenship behavior is defined as voluntary customer behaviors that are not necessary for the production or delivery of the services but benefit the organization when exhibited (Gong & Yi, 2021; Yi & Gong, 2013). According to the social exchange theory, when one of the parties involved in the exchange process receives a positive outcome from the other, a desire to reciprocate arises (Blau, 1964). In this context, customers are encouraged to perform voluntary behaviors that benefit the organization due to positive experiences (Bettencourt, 1997; Kim & Choi, 2016). Recovery satisfaction is the customer's evaluation of the solution provided by the organization for the problem experienced by the customer (Tsao, 2018). Based on the social exchange theory, customer satisfaction with the recovery ensures positive outcomes from the exchange process with the organization and generates an obligation to reciprocate (Zhu et al., 2021). In this case, the customer is likely to engage in voluntary behaviors that benefit the organization with the intention of reciprocating. Previous studies (Gong & Yi, 2021; Groth, 2005; Mitrega et al., 2022) have found that customer satisfaction with the exchange process leads to customer citizenship behavior. Following this idea, we propose the H2 and its sub-hypotheses, which state that customers' recovery satisfaction is effective on customer citizenship behavior.

H2. Recovery satisfaction positively affects customer citizenship behavior.

H2a. Recovery satisfaction positively affects advocacy.

H2b. Recovery satisfaction positively affects tolerance.

H2c. Recovery satisfaction positively affects feedback.

H2d. Recovery satisfaction positively affects helping.

2.3 | The moderating role of the failure severity

Several studies have investigated the influence of different types of justice on satisfaction (Ali et al., 2023; Smith et al., 1999; Stokburger-Sauer & Hofmann, 2023). However, the findings need to clarify which type of justice is more effective. The mixed results of the studies

support the notion that the effect of justice types on satisfaction may vary depending on various factors. In the literature (Cheng et al., 2019; Luo & Mattila, 2020; Vaerenbergh et al., 2019; Zemke & Bell, 1990), it is emphasized that there is no single recovery method that is effective against all service failures, and different types of service failures lead to further recovery expectations in customers (Miller et al., 2000). Thus, the success of the recovery is affected by the type and severity of the service failure. (Lewis & McCann, 2004; Luo & Mattila, 2020; Stokburger-Sauer & Hofmann, 2023). As service failure severity increases, customers' perceptions of loss also increase (Gelbrich & Roschk, 2011; Weun et al., 2004). In this case, the customer's perception of loss may influence the customer's attention towards different types of justice. Satisfaction can only be achieved when the service recovery is equal to the loss experienced by the customer due to service failure (McDougall & Levesque, 1998; Smith et al., 1999). In cases of severe failures, while customers expect their financial losses to be recovered (Boshoff & Leong, 1998), they may give more importance to the type of distributive justice that expresses the economic outcomes of the recovery process. On the contrary, in minor failures without any financial loss, customers give more importance to procedural and interactional justice, including recovery methods such as explanation and apology (Liao, 2007). Based on these ideas, hypothesis H3 and its sub-hypotheses, which state that service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of perceived justice types on recovery satisfaction, were developed.

H3. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of perceived justice on recovery satisfaction.

H3a. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of distributive justice on recovery satisfaction.

H3b. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of interactional justice on recovery satisfaction.

H3c. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of procedural justice on recovery satisfaction.

Sometimes, even if customers are satisfied with the recovery, their behavioral intentions may be less positive. Sparks and Fredline (2007) found that service failure severity negatively affects repurchase intention, regardless of satisfaction with the recovery. Similarly, Krishna et al., (2014) conclude that recovery methods only result in a recovery paradox in cases of moderate and low-severity service failures. Therefore, the severity of failure has a negative effect on behavioral intentions, regardless of the type of recovery. According to prospect theory (Kahneman & Tversky, 1979), people tend to pay more attention to losses than gains. Therefore, the loss experienced by the customer due to service failure is more important than the gains obtained from the recovery (Migacz, 2018). In this case, a customer who experienced severe service failure may be less willing to

engage in voluntary behavior than a customer who experienced a low severe service failure, even if they are satisfied with the recovery. Based on these ideas, H4 and its sub-hypotheses, which state that the severity of service failure has a moderating role in the effect of recovery satisfaction on customer citizenship behavior, were developed.

H4. Service failure severity moderates the effect of recovery satisfaction on customer citizenship behavior.

H4a. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of recovery satisfaction on advocacy.

H4b. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of recovery satisfaction on tolerance.

H4c. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of recovery satisfaction on feedback.

H4d. Service failure severity has a moderating role in the effect of recovery satisfaction on helping.

3 | METHODOLOGY

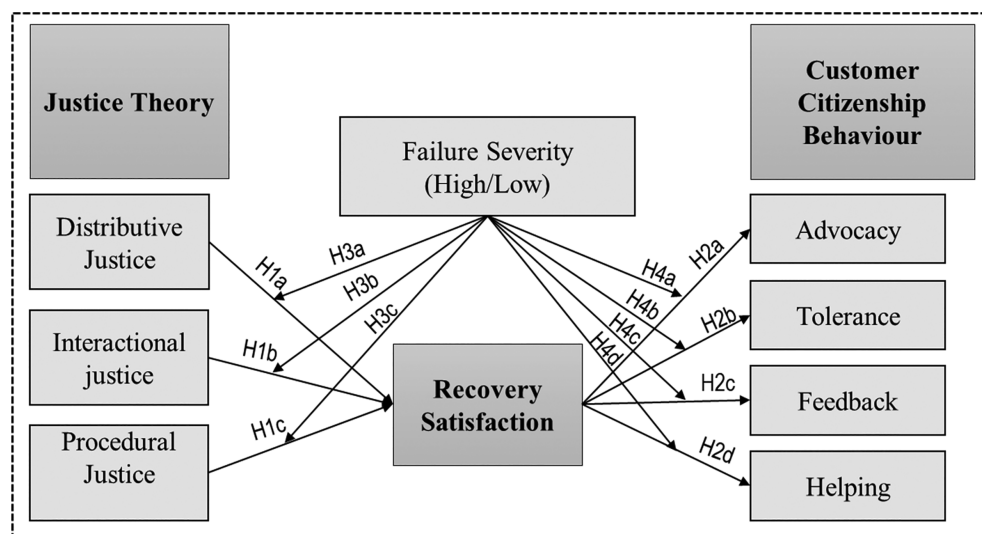
This study aims to investigate the role of failure severity in the effect of service recovery on customer citizenship behavior in the hospitality industry. Data were collected using the scenario technique to test the multi-group structural equation model developed for this purpose. The scenario technique is a semi-experimental research design that presents participants with fictional scenarios depicting incidents that may occur in real life. Participants are asked to answer questions assuming that the incidents in the scenario have happened to them (Blodgett et al., 1997; Chang et al., 2015; Fu et al., 2015; Pai et al., 2018). The scenario technique has been widely utilized in studies of service failures and recovery methods due to its advantages (Alhouthi et al., 2019; Bitner et al., 1990; Hutzinger & Weitzl, 2021; McCollough, 1995; Pai et al., 2018; Shin et al., 2018; Tang et al., 2018). Using fictional scenarios ensures that participants focus solely on the relevant subject by neutralizing external factors that may affect the study (Harris et al., 2006; Smith et al., 1999). This enhances the study's internal consistency and better explains the relationship between research variables (Bitner et al., 1990).

A multi-group scanning electron microscope (SEM) model (Figure 1) was developed based on justice theory, social exchange theory, and prospect theory to investigate the role of failure severity in the effect of service recovery on customer citizenship behavior.

3.1 | Experiential design and scenario development

In this study, we developed six scenarios ($2 \times 3 = 6$) that included two different severity of service failure (high/low) and three types of

FIGURE 1 Research model.



service recovery (apology/coupon/sapling donation). Expert opinions and secondary sources (online reviews) were used during scenario development. A high-severity service failure is when a hotel gives a room to a booked customer 1 day late due to a deficiency. On the other hand, low-severity service failure occurs when the hotel provides a room to the customer 1 h late due to the cleaning process. This choice was made since both service failures are related to the primary product (the room) of hospitality organizations and can be easily compared regarding the severity of the failure. Additionally, it was also agreed that including these service failures in the scenarios would increase the validity and realism of the scenarios, as they are frequently mentioned in online complaints and are likely to occur in real life.

A literature review was conducted to identify the tangible and intangible recovery methods that can be applied against the identified service failures (Alhouti et al., 2019; Lewis & McCann, 2004; Manu & Sreejesh, 2020; Tax et al., 1998). The results were discussed using the focus group. It was decided to apply three types of recovery for relevant service failures: apology, discount coupon, and sapling donation on behalf of the customer on online platforms. The discount coupon rate is set at 25% of the customer's paid account, while donating saplings on behalf of the customer is set at 10%.

In the scenarios, the participants were asked to imagine having made a reservation at a 5-star hotel 3 months ago for a summer holiday, and when they arrived at the hotel on the relevant date to check in, they encountered one of the service failures (high/low) mentioned above. It was stated that following their stay, they shared a review on the hotel's online platform regarding the service failure they experienced, and that the hotel responded to this review within the scope of the relevant service recovery methods (apology/discount coupon/sapling donation). Participants were asked to fill in the questionnaire considering the recovery dialog on the online platform.

3.2 | Reality and manipulation check

To test the realism of the developed scenarios, consistent with previous studies (Liu et al., 2019; Singh & Crisafulli, 2016), participants

were asked to rate their feelings on how realistic the scenario was (experimental realism) and the likelihood of it happen in real life (mundane realism) on a scale of 1–5. The literature states that values calculated above the scale's midpoint ($5 \rightarrow 2.5$; $7 \rightarrow 3.5$) are sufficient for the scenario's reality (Field, 2009; Liu et al., 2019). A one-sample *t*-test (test value = 3) was conducted to test whether the scenarios were significantly higher than the 3 averages (Table 1).

The failure severity scale (Hess et al., 2003; Liu et al., 2019) was used to determine whether the participants accurately perceived the failure severity manipulated in the scenarios. Participants were asked to rate the severity, magnitude, and significance of the failure described in the scenario using a scale of 1–5. To determine whether the manipulation of failure severity is perceived as appropriate, the perceived failure severity in the high-severity failure group should be higher than that in the low-severity failure group. In this study, participants perceived the mean of failure severity as 4.14 in the high-severity failure group and 2.76 in the low-severity failure group. The independent samples *t*-test results indicate that participants appropriately perceived the severity of the manipulated failure in the scenarios ($M_{\text{High}} = 4.14$, $SD = 0.99$ vs. $M_{\text{Low}} = 2.76$, $SD = 0.58$; $t(396) = -16.833$, $p < 0.001$) (Table 2).

Consistent with previous studies (Alhouti et al., 2019; Shin et al., 2018), the recovery manipulation checked whether participants received the recovery in the scenario using yes-no questions. The recovery manipulation check affected the sample size since participants who could not give accurate answers to the manipulation check questions were excluded from the study. In this context, the results regarding the recovery manipulation check are discussed in detail in the sample and data section.

3.3 | Sample and data collection

The study population consists of participants who have experience in online booking in the last 6 months. We followed the common practice of purposive sampling (Tax et al., 1998), which is often considered the most appropriate method in case of a limited number of

TABLE 1 Experimental and mundane realism.

Scenarios	Experimental realism			Mundane realism		
	Mean	t-Value	p-Value	Mean	t-value	p-Value
Scenario 1 (high severity/apology)	4.02	9.418	0.000	4.04	10.712	0.000
Scenario 2 (high severity/discount coupon)	3.63	5.325	0.000	3.51	2.825	0.001
Scenario 3 (high severity/sapling donation)	3.89	10.309	0.000	3.87	9.725	0.000
Scenario 4 (low severity/apology)	4.30	12.875	0.000	4.03	10.794	0.000
Scenario 5 (low severity/discount coupon)	3.75	5.687	0.000	3.60	4.753	0.000
Scenario 6 (low severity/sapling donation)	3.95	7.534	0.000	3.61	5.424	0.000

Note: Indicate that each scenario's experiential and mundane realism has a mean significantly higher than 3. Thus, it can be assumed that the developed scenarios are realistic and mundane ($t > 1.96$; $p < 0.05$).

Failure severity	Levene test		t-Test for unequal variance			
	F	p	t	df	M. Dif.	p
	52.898	0.000	-16.833	320,337	-1.38	0.000

TABLE 2 Failure severity manipulation check.**TABLE 3** Sampling and recovery manipulation check.

Sampling and recovery manipulation check questions		HS apology	HS coupon	HS donation	LS apology	LS coupon	LS donation	Total
Online reservation experience	Yes	86	89	96	86	96	88	536
	No	20	23	30	20	30	22	140
	Total	106	112	126	106	126	110	674
Recovery manipulation check	Correct	67	69	68	70	68	67	409
	False	19	20	28	16	28	21	127
	Total	86	89	96	86	96	88	536

Note: Bold values indicate total number of participants.
Abbreviations: HS, high sever failure; LS, low sever failure.

respondents with unique experiences to contribute to the study (Weitzel, 2019). Respondents were asked a screening question to determine if they had made an online reservation in the past 6 months. The response category was dichotomous, either “yes” or “no.” Respondents who answered “no” were excluded, whereas those with a “yes” response was invited to complete the follow-up questionnaire.

The online questionnaire forms were randomly emailed to 2000 people from the previously created email repository. A total of 674 responses were received. Table 3 shows the number of participants by scenario.

Of the 674 participants who answered the screening question, 536 responded yes and were directed to the questionnaire follow-up. The 140 participants who answered no were excluded from the study.

To verify that the respondents accurately understood the scenarios' recovery methods, manipulation check questions were added to the questionnaire. When recovery was offered in the form of discount coupons or apologies, the questionnaire asked, “Were you offered a discount coupon according to the scenario?” When recovery was offered in the form of sapling donations, the questionnaire included the question, “Were saplings donated on your behalf according to the

scenario?” For six scenarios, 536 participants answered the manipulation check question. Of the total number of participants, 409 provided correct answers, while 127 were excluded from the study due to their incorrect answers.

A total of 409 valid questionnaires were obtained from screening and manipulation check questions. Due to unanswered questions, 13 questionnaires were excluded from the study. With 66 participants per scenario, a total of 396 questionnaires were used for further analysis.

Various techniques are utilized to determine the sample size in research studies. Common practice is calculating the minimum sample size based on the method used in the research (e.g., Alhouthi et al., 2019; Singh & Crisafulli, 2016). According to Hair et al. (2014), it is recommended that each group in samples consisting of multiple groups should have at least 20 observations. In covariance-based structural equation models, it is recommended that the minimum sample size be 10 times the number of items in the measurement model (Byrne, 2016; Hair et al., 2008). The study used a sample size of 396, with 66 per scenario, meeting the minimum sample size requirement of 10 times the number of items for covariance-based structural equation models (Byrne, 2016) as well as the 20-sample size

requirement for the minimum number of samples per group for multi-group analysis (Hair et al., 2008).

An additional issue to consider when determining the sample size is the sample's representativeness to the population. According to Kozak (2018), a sample size of 384 is considered sufficient to achieve a 95% reliability level in studies conducted on a population of over 100,000. The study population consisted of individuals with online booking experience totaling 100,000 or more. In this context, a sample size of 384 or more can be considered sufficient to represent the population.

3.4 | Measures

The scales used in this study were obtained from previous studies in the literature. Procedural justice (4), interactional justice (5), and distributive justice (4) scales were developed by Blodgett et al. (1997) and used in many studies (Cheng et al., 2019; Karatepe, 2006; Kim et al., 2009; Smith et al., 1999) on service failures and recovery methods in the hospitality industry. The recovery satisfaction scale (4) was developed by Roschk and Kaiser (2013) and later adapted by Liu et al. (2019) in the context of online complaints in the hospitality industry. The customer citizenship behavior scale was developed by Yi and Gong (2013) as a 4-dimensional construct consisting of advocacy (3), feedback (3), tolerance (3), and helping (4) behaviors and adapted to the hospitality industry by Assiouras et al. (2019).

The study was conducted in Turkey, so the questionnaire must be translated into Turkish. To ensure the accuracy of the version, a back-translation was used. Prior to data collection, a pre-test was conducted with 60 respondents, allocating 10 to each scenario. The method was found to have no significant issues, and minor problems were corrected by modifying the instructions. All the measurement items for the constructs were assessed using a five-point Likert scale from 1 = Strongly Disagree to 5 = Strongly Agree.

3.5 | Reliability and validity

Confirmatory factor analysis was conducted to assess the internal consistency of the measurement model. The items' reliability and validity (convergent and discriminant validity) were evaluated following the guidelines provided by Hair et al. (2014). Hair et al. (2014) state that three criteria must be fulfilled to assess convergent validity. That is, the standardized factor loadings should be significantly related to the latent construct and have a loading estimate of at least 0.60, the average variance extracted value (AVE) should be greater than 0.50, and the constructs should have a reliability value (CR and Cronbach Alpha) greater than 0.70. Referring to Table 4, all standardized item loadings were more significant than 0.60. Additionally, the AVE for all constructs exceeded 0.50, and the reliability score exceeded 0.70, indicating that convergent validity was achieved. Moreover, the skewness and kurtosis values ranging between +1.5 and -1.5 indicate a normal distribution (Tabachnick & Fidell, 2007).

In the first confirmatory factor analysis applied to the measurement model, covariance errors were observed between IJ_4 and IJ_5 (MI = 143.412; PC = 0.190) and between RS_1 and RS_2 (MI = 142.909; PC = 0.206), leading to model misspecification. We gradually established covariance between the error terms of these items to improve model fit values. Setting a reasonable number of covariances between items belonging to the same construct to improve model fit is a common and accepted practice in the literature (Byrne, 2016).

According to Hair et al. (2014), a good fit for the measurement model should have a GFI (goodness of fit index) greater than 0.90, an RMSEA (root mean square error of approximation) less than 0.08, a TLI (Tucker-Lewis index) greater than 0.90, and a CFI (comparative fit index) greater than 0.90. Table 4 presents the model-appropriate values obtained after establishing covariances ($\chi^2 = 929,202$; d.f. = 375; $\chi^2/\text{d.f.} = 2478$; CFI = 0.945; NFI = 0.912; TLI = 0.936; RMSEA = 0.061). The goodness-of-fit Indices for the measurement model indicate a good fit (Byrne, 2016; Gaskin, 2021; Hair et al., 2014).

We followed the procedure Fornell and Lacker (1981) recommended to assess discriminant validity. According to their recommendations, the squared correlation between each pair of latent variables must be less than the AVE of each latent variable to ensure discriminant validity. As shown in Table 5, the AVE of the underlying constructs exceeded the squared correlation with other constructs.

3.6 | Invariance analysis of measurement model

To ensure the validity of comparisons between multiple groups, it is recommended that all groups interpret the measurement model similarly (Byrne, 2016). To check this issue, invariance analysis is performed by comparing the χ^2 and *df* values of the configural model with the constrained model (Byrne, 2016). If the χ^2 value for both models differed by more than 3.84 at one degree of freedom (*df* = 1), indicating a significant difference (Bagozzi & Heatherton, 1994; Byrne, 2016). This result is interpreted as the measurement model being understood differently by different groups, which is an obstacle in terms of multiple group comparisons. On the other hand, if the χ^2 differences calculated for each degree of freedom are less than 3.84, it can be concluded that the invariance condition has been met (Byrne, 2016; Yoo, 2002).

Based on the results shown in Table 6, the participants in both the low and high-severity failure groups understood the measurement model in the same way ($\chi^2 = 24.296$, *df* = 19, $p > 0.05$). Therefore, the measurement model can be compared between these groups.

4 | FINDINGS

As shown in Table 7, most of the participants consist of females. In terms of date of birth, those born between 1981 and 1999 have the highest participation rate. Married people make up the

TABLE 4 The analysis of reliability and validity for the construct.

Constructs	Items	Mean	SD	Skewness	Kurtosis	t-Value	Factor loading
Distributive justice AVE: 0.828 CR: 0.951 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.950	DJ_1	2.939	1.1611	0.031	−0.907	25.798	0.900
	DJ_2	2.924	1.1020	0.059	−0.779	28.068	0.935
	DJ_3	2.896	1.1460	0.011	−0.845	280.40	0.934
	DJ_4	3.045	1.1151	−0.112	−0.924	–	0.870
Interactional justice AVE: 0.708 CR: 0.923 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.920	IJ_1	3.924	0.8078	−0.612	0.413	–	0.876
	IJ_2	3.904	0.8212	−0.590	0.292	26.245	0.916
	IJ_3	3.912	0.8388	−0.709	0.536	23.730	0.870
	IJ_4	3.816	0.9699	−0.525	−0.311	19.021	0.769
	IJ_5	3.785	0.9557	−0.502	−0.267	18.905	0.766
Procedural justice AVE: 0.683 CR: 0.896 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.889	PJ_1	3.949	0.8035	−0.671	0.705	–	0.852
	PJ_2	3.806	0.8569	−0.463	0.132	21.982	0.877
	PJ_3	3.836	0.8484	−0.678	0.632	19.986	0.825
	PJ_4	3.813	0.8512	−0.473	0.094	17.163	0.746
Recovery satisfaction AVE: 0.707 CR: 0.905 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.903	RS_1	3.896	0.9178	−0.699	0.130	–	0.722
	RS_2	3.788	0.9059	−0.634	0.255	24.298	0.757
	RS_3	3.424	1.0515	−0.336	−0.415	18.606	0.942
	RS_4	3.543	1.0041	−0.358	−0.476	18.249	0.921
Advocacy AVE: 0.839 CR: 0.940 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.935	AD_1	3.154	1.0307	−0.117	−0.427	–	0.890
	AD_2	3.061	1.1189	−0.043	−0.709	30.884	0.959
	AD_3	3.010	1.1069	0.337	−0.645	26.922	0.897
Tolerance AVE: 0.647 CR: 0.846 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.840	TOL_1	2.492	0.9399	0.306	−0.253	–	0.738
	TOL_2	2.773	0.9134	0.224	−0.127	15.513	0.839
	TOL_3	2.715	0.8898	0.158	0.108	15.450	0.833
Feedback AVE: 0.634 CR: 0.838 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.830	FB_1	3.611	0.8570	−0.468	−0.098	–	0.710
	FB_2	3.798	0.8235	−0.592	0.270	14.437	0.856
	FB_3	3.952	0.7396	−0.600	−0.898	14.210	0.816
Helping AVE: 0.572 CR: 0.842 Cronbach's Alpha: 0.841	HEL_1	3.096	0.7801	0.184	−0.440	–	0.729
	HEL_2	3.169	0.7822	−0.051	−0.385	13.996	0.783
	HEL_3	3.187	0.8178	−0.133	−0.528	14.248	0.803
	HEL_4	3.384	0.7886	−0.513	−0.305	12.778	0.706

Note: $\chi^2 = 929.202$; $df = 375$; $\chi^2/df = 2478$; CFI = 0.945; NFI = 0.912; TLI = 0.936; RMSEA = 0.061.

majority of those surveyed regarding marital status. As for the education level, those with a postgraduate degree make up most of the participants.

4.1 | Structural model and hypothesis testing

This study employed a multi-group structural equation model. The model was first conducted using the total sample and then run again with multiple groups to determine the moderating effects of failure severity. Table 8 presents the model goodness-of-fit Indices, path coefficients (β), p -values, and t -values for the entire sample. The Goodness-of-fit Indices for the model indicate a good fit (Byrne, 2016; Hair et al., 2014).

The results show that procedural, interactional, and distributive justice positively affect recovery satisfaction ($p < 0.001$). In this case, hypotheses H_{1a} , H_{1b} , and H_{1c} are supported. Based on the results obtained from the full sample, distributive justice ($\beta = 0.417$) was found to be the most effective type of justice in terms of recovery satisfaction, followed by interactional justice ($\beta = 0.333$) and procedural justice ($\beta = 0.217$).

Hypotheses H_{2a} , H_{2b} , H_{2c} , and H_{2d} , stating the effect of recovery satisfaction on the types of customer citizenship behaviors, are also supported ($p < 0.001$). Recovery satisfaction positively affects advocacy ($\beta = 0.782$), tolerance ($\beta = 0.631$), feedback ($\beta = 0.498$), and helping ($\beta = 0.340$) behaviors, respectively.

The model's ability to explain the proportion of variance in the dependent variable is assessed by the R^2 values. When evaluating R^2 ,

TABLE 5 Discriminant validity (Fornell–Larcker).

Constructs	Fornell–Larcker criteria							
	DJ	IJ	PJ	RS	AD	TOL	FB	HEL
DJ	0.910							
IJ	0.560***	0.842						
PJ	0.553***	0.698***	0.826					
RS	0.701***	0.721***	0.702***	0.841				
AD	0.490***	0.483***	0.563***	0.618***	0.916			
TOL	0.467***	0.427***	0.441***	0.592***	0.409***	0.805		
FB	0.371***	0.442***	0.390***	0.462***	0.406***	0.409***	0.796	
HEL	0.227***	0.253***	0.318***	0.338***	0.172**	0.223***	0.263***	0.756

Note: Bold values are the square root of the AVE.

Abbreviations: AD, advocacy; DJ, distributive justice; FB, feedback; HEL, helping; IJ, interactional justice; PJ, procedural justice; RS, recovery satisfaction; TOL, tolerance.

* $p < 0.050$;

** $p < 0.010$; *** $p < 0.001$.

TABLE 6 Invariance analysis.

Model	χ^2	df	p	Invariant
Configural model	1451.687	755		
Fully constrained model	1475.983	774	0.185	Yes

TABLE 7 Demographic findings.

Item	Answer	n	%
Gender	Female	208	52.5
	Male	188	47.5
Date of birth	1999 and later	23	5.8
	1981–1998	276	69.4
	1965–1980	89	22.5
	1946–1964	9	2.3
Marital status	Single	175	44.2
	Married	221	55.8
Education	Primary School	2	0.5
	High School	18	4.5
	University	136	34.3
	Postgraduate	242	61.6

a value of 0.67 or higher indicates a high level of explanation. In contrast, a value between 0.33 and 0.67 indicates a medium level, and a value between 0.29 and 0.33 indicates a weak level of explanation (Chin, 1998). According to relevant reference values, distributive, interactional, and procedural justice explain recovery satisfaction ($R^2 = 0.678$) at a high level. Recovery satisfaction demonstrates advocacy ($R^2 = 0.611$) and tolerance ($R^2 = 0.398$) at a medium level, feedback ($R^2 = 0.248$), and helping ($R^2 = 0.116$) at a weak level. The results indicate that feedback and helping behaviors are primarily influenced by variables not included in the research model.

This study examined the moderating effect of failure severity on the research model using a multi-group structural equation model. The study utilized the χ^2 differences method to assess whether the path coefficients between the groups differed significantly (Byrne, 2004; Byrne, 2016). Table 9 presents both groups' path coefficients, p -values, χ^2 values, and χ^2 differences.

The results of the multi-group analysis indicate that hypotheses H_{3a} ($\chi^2 = 0.251$), H_{3b} ($\chi^2 = 2.429$), and H_{3c} ($\chi^2 = 1.397$), which state that the failure severity moderates the effect of justice types on recovery satisfaction, was rejected. There are differences in the path coefficients (β) of the groups. However, these differences did not reach a significant level ($\Delta\chi^2 < 3840$). Thus, the effect of justice types on recovery satisfaction is not moderated by the severity of the failure.

The results confirm that failure severity moderates the effect of recovery satisfaction on advocacy ($\Delta\chi^2 = 4.462$) and tolerance ($\Delta\chi^2 = 9.557$) behaviors. Therefore, H_{4a} and H_{4c} are supported. Examination of the β coefficients indicates that recovery satisfaction has a more significant effect on advocacy behavior for participants who experienced low-severity failure ($\beta = 0.786$) than those who experienced high-severity failure ($\beta = 0.531$). Similarly, recovery satisfaction more significantly affects the tolerance behavior of participants who experienced a low-severity failure ($\beta = 0.724$) than those who experienced a high-severity failure ($\beta = 0.503$). According to the results, customers who experience high-severity service failure exhibit lower levels of advocacy and tolerance behavior than those who experience low-severity service failure, even if they are satisfied with the recovery.

Although there is a difference between groups in the effect of recovery satisfaction on feedback ($\Delta\chi^2 = 0.247$) and helping ($\Delta\chi^2 = 0.116$) behaviors, the failure severity does not moderate the effect as the differences in χ^2 do not reach the significance level. Thus, hypotheses H_{4b} and H_{4c} were rejected. The results for the total sample and groups are presented separately in Figure 2.

Hypothesis	β	t	SD	r^2	p
H _{1a} : Distributive justice → Recovery satisfaction	0.417	8.805	0.033	0.678	0.000
H _{1b} : Interactional justice → Recovery satisfaction	0.333	5.945	0.051	0.678	0.000
H _{1c} : Procedural justice → Recovery satisfaction	0.217	4.029	0.058	0.678	0.000
H _{2a} : Recovery satisfaction → Advocacy	0.782	14.391	0.071	0.611	0.000
H _{2b} : Recovery satisfaction → Tolerance	0.631	10.080	0.063	0.398	0.000
H _{2c} : Recovery satisfaction → Feedback	0.498	8.151	0.055	0.248	0.000
H _{2d} : Recovery satisfaction → Helping	0.340	5.837	0.049	0.116	0.000

TABLE 8 Structural parameter estimates and goodness-of-fit indices.

Note: $\chi^2 = 1043.677$; $df = 393$; $\chi^2/df = 2.656$; CFI = 0.935; NFI = 0.899; TLI = 0.928; RMSEA = 0.065.

TABLE 9 Results of multi-group analysis.

Path	Low severity			High severity			χ^2 difference	
	β	S.S.	t	β	S.S.	t	χ^2	$\Delta\chi^2$
H3a: DJ → RS	0.313***	0.039	5.445	0.425***	0.050	5.822	1571.233	1.397
H3b: IJ → RS	0.431***	0.082	5.008	0.295***	0.061	4.068	1572.265	2.429
H3c: PJ → RS	0.277***	0.081	3.722	0.239***	0.081	3.005	1570.087	0.251
H4a: RS → AD	0.786***	0.087	10.754	0.531***	0.098	6.624	1574.298	4.462*
H4b: RS → TOL	0.724***	0.086	8.177	0.503***	0.068	4.894	1579.393	9.557**
H4c: RS → FB	0.503***	0.077	6.057	0.456***	0.080	5.127	1570.083	0.247
H4d: RS → HEL	0.356***	0.088	4.473	0.335***	0.072	3.915	1569.952	0.116

Note: $\chi^2 = 1569.836$; $df = 786$; $\chi^2/df = 1.997$; CFI = 0.921; NFI = 0.855; TLI = 0.913; RMSEA = 0.050.

* $p < 0.05$;

** $p < 0.01$;

*** $p < 0.001$.

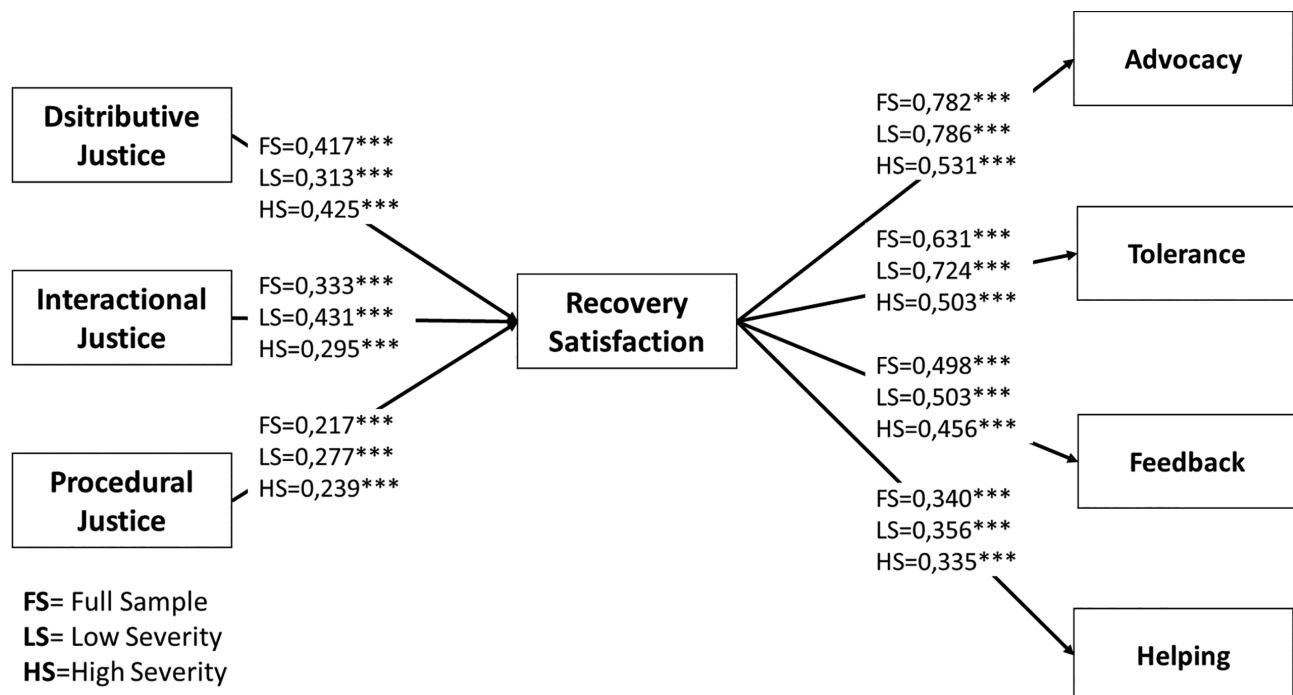


FIGURE 2 Results of full sample and groups.

5 | CONCLUSION AND DISCUSSION

5.1 | Discussion

This study aims to transform the negative consequences of service failures that are expressed in the form of online negative reviews into positive outcomes through the responses provided by management. In this context, customer citizenship behavior was examined as a potential positive outcome of responding to negative online reviews that report varying levels of service failures through the theoretical lenses of justice theory, social exchange theory, and prospect theory. The results indicate that it is possible to encourage customer citizenship behavior by implementing effective recovery strategies in response to negative reviews.

The findings revealed that customers' perceptions of justice affect their satisfaction with recovery. According to the justice theory (Blodgett et al., 1997; Tax et al., 1998), satisfaction increases as the perceived justice increases. There is a consensus among authors (Ali et al., 2023; Jung & Seock, 2017; Manu & Sreejesh, 2020; Smith et al., 1999) that justice perceptions influence recovery satisfaction positively. However, conflicting results exist regarding the effectiveness of different types of justice. While some authors (Ding & Lii, 2016; Kim et al., 2009; Kuo & Wu, 2012; Smith et al., 1999) have found distributive justice to be more effective, others (Blodgett et al., 1997; Karatepe, 2006; Rojas et al., 2015; Tax et al., 1998) have found interactional justice to be more effective. This study indicated that distributive justice is the most influential justice type regarding recovery satisfaction for full sample.

The conflicting results in the literature comparing the effect of justice types on recovery satisfaction (Ali et al., 2023; Smith et al., 1999; Stokburger-Sauer & Hofmann, 2023) can be explained by the different recovery expectations following different types of service failures (Miller et al., 2000). A multi-group structural equation model was employed to examine the effects of justice types on recovery satisfaction, with particular attention to the differential effects across groups with varying levels of failure severity. The results indicate no significant difference in customers' recovery satisfaction based on their perceptions of justice types concerning failure severity. However, minor differences that did not reach significance caused the order of the effect of perceived justice types on recovery satisfaction to change, and the most influential justice type on recovery satisfaction differed by group. In the high-severity failure group, distributive justice has the most significant impact on recovery satisfaction. Conversely, interactional justice is the most effective in the low-severity failure group. This result can be interpreted as customers who experience different types of service failures giving more importance to different types of justice. Consistent with our findings Liao (2007) found that apologies and explanations (interactional justice) are sufficient for low-severity failures. However, monetary recovery (distributive justice) becomes more critical in compensating for high-severity failures that cause customer financial loss. Similarly, Boshoff and Leong (1998) state that when the customer experience a financial loss,

apology and courtesy are not enough; the customer's financial loss should also be compensated.

The results demonstrate that recovery satisfaction has a positive effect on customer citizenship behavior. Although, numerous studies (Bettencourt, 1997; Groth, 2005; Yi & Gong, 2006) have found that customer satisfaction has a positive impact on customer citizenship behavior, only one study (Zhu et al., 2021) has investigated customer citizenship behavior in the context of service failures and recovery methods. In accordance with our findings, Zhu et al. (2021) found that recovery satisfaction has a positive effect on customer citizenship behavior in e-retail settings. Therefore, it is vital to ensure recovery satisfaction to encourage customer citizenship behavior following a service failure.

This study focuses on four distinct types of customer citizenship behaviors: advocacy, tolerance, feedback, and helping. Although recovery satisfaction has a positive effect on all types of customer citizenship behaviors, it is found to be more effective, particularly in the context of advocacy and tolerance. In the hospitality industry, it is well established that potential consumers are more likely to consider experiences and recommendations shared by previous consumers (Filiari et al., 2018; Liu & Park, 2015). Thus, advocacy behavior, which refers to spreading positive opinions about an organization (Yi & Gong, 2013), is crucial for hospitality organizations. In addition, tolerance behavior can result in a more favorable attitude toward the organization, even in instances where customer expectations are not met. This can help organizations in maintaining relationship with their customers and preventing the sharing of negative reviews about the organization (Woo, 2019). Therefore, it is of paramount importance for organizations to cultivate a tolerance behavior, as it has a significant effect on the current and future relationships with customers.

According to the results, the research model explains feedback and helping behaviors at a low level. These findings support that feedback and helping behaviors are explained by variables not included in the model. When the related literature examines (Bove et al., 2009; Chen et al., 2019; Delpechitre et al., 2018; Gong & Yi, 2021; Hossain et al., 2020; Mitrega et al., 2022; Rosenbaum & Massiah, 2007; Woo, 2019; Yi & Gong, 2008a; Yi & Gong, 2008b), it is seen that customer citizenship behavior is affected by many factors including customers, employees, other customers, service, and organization. This study's focus on only customer-related features, such as recovery satisfaction, among other antecedents, may have led to the low explanation of feedback and helping behaviors. For instance, Li and Wei (2020) examined the effect of customer involvement on customer citizenship behavior and found that feedback and helping behaviors were explained at a high level. Therefore, it can be concluded that feedback and helping behaviors are primarily explained by factors such as customer involvement rather than satisfaction.

This study utilized a multi-group structural equation model to examine the effect of recovery satisfaction on customer citizenship behavior for high and low-severity failure groups. The results revealed that while failure severity moderates the effect of recovery satisfaction on advocacy and tolerance behaviors, it does not moderate the

effect of feedback and helping behaviors. Recovery satisfaction is more effective on advocacy and tolerance behaviors at low-severity service failures, whereas at high-severity service failures, this effect decreases. Although there is no study in the literature that investigates the impact of failure severity on customer citizenship behavior, numerous studies are demonstrated that it has a negative effect on behavioral intentions (Cho et al., 2017; Hur & Jang, 2016; Krishna et al., 2014; Sparks & Fredline, 2007). Cho et al. (2017) state that high-severity service failures have a negative effect on post-recovery attitudes and behaviors. Sparks and Fredline (2007) found that failure severity negatively affects repurchase intention, regardless of the success of the recovery. Similarly, Krishna et al., (2014) concluded that successful recovery methods applied only for moderate and low-severity service failures lead to recovery paradoxes. In the context of prospect theory (Kahneman & Tversky, 1979), it can be said that as the severity of failure increases, the effect of positive experiences following a recovery on behavioral intentions decreases. This can be explained by the fact that people give more importance to negative experiences than positive ones. Moreover, belief updating process theory (Boulding et al., 1993) states that each new encounter between the organization and the customer involves a process in which the customer obtains more experience and updates his/her beliefs about the organization. This implies that the recovery process can transform the negative customer beliefs of service failure into positive ones. While updating their belief about the organization, customers are also influenced by their prior negative experiences. Thus, the severity of negative experiences resulting from service failure can affect the beliefs updated during the recovery process. The study's results support this idea. The severity of the failure that leads to a negative customer experience impacts post-recovery behavioral intentions.

5.2 | Theoretical contribution

This study contributes to the literature on service failures in hospitality organizations in several ways. First, addressing customer citizenship behavior in the context of service failures contributes to a better understanding of a neglected issue in hospitality businesses. This study is the first to consider customer citizenship behavior as a positive outcome of successful recovery in the hospitality industry. Additionally, it provides essential insights into the circumstances that may lead to the development of customer citizenship behavior following a service failure. The findings indicate that high-severity failures hinder the growth of customer citizenship behavior regardless of recovery. On the other hand, successful recoveries following low-severity failures are more likely to result in customer citizenship behavior. These findings are considered significant contributions to the literature.

Secondly, this study employs an experiential design to address service failures and recovery methods in the context of online platforms. Online platforms have a profound impact on the hospitality industry (Akhtar et al., 2019; Chen et al., 2022; Kontis & Skoultzos, 2022; Tengilimoğlu & Hassan, 2020; Sotiriadis, 2016; Zhou

et al., 2019), yet they are largely neglected in the context of service failures. Currently, it is known that customers move their service failure experience to online platforms (Fu et al., 2022; Honora et al., 2022; Liu et al., 2019). Therefore, the development of online recovery strategies for service failures shared on online platforms is of critical importance for hospitality organizations, which are heavily influenced by shared experiences. This study makes a significant contribution to the literature by focusing on recovery dialogues on online platforms and their impact on customer perceptions and attitudes.

Finally, this study confirms the inconsistent results found in previous studies that compared the effect of justice types on recovery satisfaction (Ali et al., 2023; Stokburger-Sauer & Hofmann, 2023). According to the results, customers tend to direct greater attention to the interactional justice in the context of low-severity failures, whereas they tend to prioritize the distributive justice in the context of high-severity failures. Therefore, this study provides an explanation to the inconsistent results about which type of justice is more effective on recovery satisfaction by focusing on the failure severity. Empirical evidence is provided that failure severity is one of the factors that leads customers to give more importance to different types of justice in terms of recovery satisfaction.

5.3 | Practical implications

The results of this study provide several implications for hospitality organizations in managing the online service recovery process. Nowadays, service failures are widely shared on online platforms (Grégoire et al., 2018). The literature (Liu et al., 2019; Xie et al., 2017) states that the response rate of hospitality organizations to negative reviews is relatively low. However, as seen in this study, developing recovery strategies for service failures shared online can transform negative customer attitudes and behaviors into positive ones. In this context, managers should develop effective recovery strategies to mitigate negative outcomes and transform them positively, instead of ignoring service failures reported online. The results show that customers who experienced different levels of failure give more importance to different types of justice. Therefore, it is vital to determine the severity of the failure to develop effective recovery strategies. Review scores can be used to determine the severity of service failures on online platforms (Liu et al., 2019). For low-severity failure, non-monetary elements such as apology, explanation, and quick response, which improve perceptions of interactional and procedural justice, have more positive results. On the other hand, for high-severity failures, monetary elements such as coupons, discounts, and refunds that improve perceptions of distributive justice have more positive outcomes. Therefore, it is essential to develop recovery strategies according to the severity of the failure to prevent unnecessary financial loss and encourage more positive behavioral intentions.

The results of this study show that online recovery methods foster customer citizenship behavior intentions. The aim of recovery is not only to avoid the negative consequences of service failures but also to ensure positive behavioral intentions (Kim et al., 2009).

Moreover, the recovery dialogues that take place on online platforms are also observed by other customers (Roozen & Raedts, 2018). Therefore, online recovery is crucial in retaining customers and developing positive behavioral intentions in the victims and potential customers (Hutzing & Weitzl, 2021; Stevens et al., 2018). However, the severity of the failure experienced by the customer affects the development of positive behavioral intentions. The results show that it is more difficult for customers to develop citizenship behaviors in high-severity failures than in low-severity failures. Thus, the severity of the failure leads to challenges in developing positive behavioral intentions. In this context, it is obvious that it is more difficult to avoid the negative consequences of high-severity failures and turn them into positive outcomes. In this respect, minimizing the severity of service failures is crucial, even if they cannot be prevented entirely.

5.4 | Limitations and future research

This study has some limitations. It is important to note that the results of this study are limited to the service failures and recovery methods that were manipulated in the scenarios. Thus, different scenarios with different service failures and recovery methods may lead to different results. Although manipulation check questions were included in the study to assess whether participants correctly understood the scenarios, it must be acknowledged that the findings obtained are confined to the rate of correct scenario comprehension by the participants.

Recovery dialogues occurring on online platforms are transparent for observer customers (Roozen & Raedts, 2018). Thus, online recovery affects not only victims' customers, but also observer customers (Javornik et al., 2020). The impact of recovery dialogues on observer customers is a new and less studied topic recently emerging in the literature on service failures and recovery methods. Future studies focusing on the perceptions and attitudes of observer customers would provide meaningful contributions to the literature and hospitality practitioners. Furthermore, cultural background may lead to differences in the attitudes of both victim and observer customers (Ülker et al., 2021; Zhang et al., 2020). In this respect, focusing on cultural background in future studies can provide important contributions to the literature in understanding differentiated customer behavior.

DATA AVAILABILITY STATEMENT

The data that support the findings of this study are available from the corresponding author upon reasonable request.

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